

Mastering Phrasal Verbs

Literal, Metaphorical & Multiple
Meanings

Practice & Discovery

What is a Phrasal Verb?

- A phrasal verb is a verb combined with a preposition or adverb (or both) that takes on a new meaning.
- Examples:
 - - take off
 - - look after
 - - break down

Literal vs. Metaphorical Usage

- Literal: She looked up at the sky.
- Metaphorical: She looked up the word in a dictionary.
- Some phrasal verbs have multiple meanings depending on the context.

Matching Activity: Literal or Metaphorical?

- Example: 'Break down'
- 1. The car broke down on the highway.
(Literal)
- 2. He broke down in tears. (Metaphorical)
- → Can you tell which is which?

Phrasal Verbs: Movement

- Phrasal Verbs about Movement:
 - - get in
 - - go out
 - - come across
- Discuss: Can these be used both literally and metaphorically?

Phrasal Verbs: Change

- Phrasal Verbs about Change:
 - - grow up
 - - turn into
- Discuss: Can these be used both literally and metaphorically?

Phrasal Verbs: Conflict

- Phrasal Verbs about Conflict:
 - - fall out
 - - break up
- Discuss: Can these be used both literally and metaphorically?

Phrasal Verbs: Communication

- Phrasal Verbs about Communication:
 - - speak up
 - - bring up
- Discuss: Can these be used both literally and metaphorically?

Phrasal Verbs: Emotions

- Phrasal Verbs about Emotions:
 - - cheer up
 - - freak out
- Discuss: Can these be used both literally and metaphorically?

Multiple Meanings: Take off

- Take off can mean:
- - Remove (clothes)
- - Plane departs
- - Become popular

Multiple Meanings: Set up

- Set up can mean:
- - Arrange/prepare
- - Frame someone

Multiple Meanings: Break up

- Break up can mean:
- - End a relationship
- - Distorted audio

Common Errors

- - Mixing up particles (give up vs give in)
- - Misplacing object pronouns
- - Using phrasal verbs in formal writing

- → Practice makes perfect!

Summary & Tips

- Literal vs. Metaphorical meanings
- Context is key
- Use visual memory (imagine the action)
- Create your own sentences!

Homework / Extension

- - Keep a phrasal verb diary: 2 per day
- - Write an anecdote using 5 phrasal verbs
- - Find phrasal verbs in songs or films